

SAINT AGNES MERCY HOSPITAL

Department of Human Resources — Employee Conduct Policy

Policy No. HR-114 | Effective Date: January 1, 2024 | Last Revised: March 2025 | Page 1 of 1

Section 4: Workplace Violence & Physical Altercations

4.1 Policy Statement. Saint Agnes Mercy Hospital is committed to maintaining a safe environment for all patients, visitors, and employees. The Hospital maintains a strict zero-tolerance policy regarding workplace violence. Fighting, physical altercations, assault, or threatening behavior of any kind are strictly prohibited on Hospital premises.

4.2 Prohibited Conduct. The following conduct is expressly prohibited and constitutes gross misconduct:

- Engaging in any physical altercation or fight with a patient, visitor, vendor, or fellow employee;
- Striking, pushing, grabbing, or otherwise making unwanted physical contact with another person;
- Threatening, intimidating, or provoking another person to violence;
- Any conduct that endangers the safety of patients, visitors, or staff.

4.3 Disciplinary Action. Because of the serious risk such conduct poses to patient safety, any employee who engages in a physical altercation while on Hospital premises is subject to **immediate termination of employment for gross misconduct, without prior warning and without the standard progressive discipline process.** The Hospital reserves the right to terminate employment effective immediately upon confirmation of such conduct.

4.4 No Prior Warning Required. Given the severity of workplace violence and the Hospital's duty to protect patients, a documented prior warning is *not* a prerequisite to termination under this Section. A single substantiated incident is sufficient grounds for immediate dismissal.

4.5 Self-Defense. Employees are expected to disengage from any confrontation and immediately summon Security (ext. 2200) rather than engage physically. Continued physical engagement beyond what is strictly necessary to remove oneself from danger is not protected under this policy.

Employee Acknowledgment. I acknowledge that I have received, read, and understand the Saint Agnes Mercy Hospital Workplace Violence & Physical Altercations Policy. I understand that a violation of this policy may result in immediate termination of my employment.

Employee Signature / Date